



Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Mr. Rawson • GCSE Physics

Study Techniques

Mr. Rawson's Raw-est Study Method

Next test: Tuesday 6 October, Period 3

Every one of you can do very well on a physics test. When there is a gap between what a student can do and the mark they get, it nearly always comes down to how they studied. The best way to study is to practise in conditions that look like the test, so that on the day the test feels familiar.

Write everything out on paper

Do your studying with a pencil in your hand, in a notebook kept just for physics. Set out every page so that you can **find the worksheet and the question again later**.

1. Write the name of the worksheet or topic at the top of the page, with the date.
2. Write the number of each question in the left-hand margin.
3. Write out every step, starting with the original formula. The question itself can stay on the worksheet, as long as the heading and the number lead you back to it.
4. Put a **star** next to any question you got wrong, so you know which topics to review later.

When you finish, the paper is a record of exactly what you did and how much you studied, and anything you were unsure about is written down, ready to ask about in class.

Set up like a test

- Sit at a desk, in a quiet room, with everything you need in front of you: notebook, pencil, calculator, ruler and the equation sheet.
- Switch your phone off and leave it in another room for the whole session.
- Keep open only the question paper you are working from.

Work the problems yourself

- Answer each question on your own, all the way to a final answer, before you open the mark scheme.
- Mark it against the scheme in a different colour, then do the questions you dropped marks on again, from a blank page, a day or two later.
- Keep going until you can do every type of question with the mark scheme closed. Doing questions is how you learn physics, and reading notes is the warm-up.
- Try each question alone first, and talk it through with a friend afterwards.

Study in focused blocks

- Work in blocks of at least 30 minutes, an hour is best, and stay in your seat for the whole block.
- Between blocks take a short break, get up, stretch, get a drink and something to eat.

Plan your week

- Write your study times into your planner for every day before the test, and keep to them.
- Have at least three-quarters of your studying done before the night before the test, so that last evening is a light review.
- Show this sheet at home, or to your houseparent, and ask them to help you stick to your plan.

Look after yourself

- Eat proper meals at regular times, and get a full night's sleep before the test.
- Pack your kit the night before: pencil, pen, ruler, calculator and a protractor.